Which countries are achieving the UN Sustainable Development Goals fastest?

The ultimate aim of the Sustainable Development Goals is to end poverty, protect the planet and ensure prosperity for everyone. Each goal has specific targets that need to be met by 2030.

So how close are countries to meeting them? To find out, non-profit organization Bertelsmann Stiftung and the UN Sustainable Development Solutions Network have created a prototype index that measures their performance.

Sweden leads the list, followed by Denmark and Finland. Among the G7 countries, only Germany and France can be found among the top ten performers. The United States ranks 42nd on the Index, while Russia and China rank 62nd and 71st respectively. Also in the top 20 were Canada (13th), the Czech Republic (15th) and Slovenia (17th). Asia-Pacific's top performers Japan, Singapore and Australia rounded off the list at 18th, 19th and 20th, respectively. The SDG Index underlines that despite achieving high percentages, all countries still have their work cut out to close the remaining gap.

India ranks 116 out of 157 nations on a global index that assesses the performance of countries towards achieving the ambitious sustainable development goals (SDGs).

GLOSSARY

1. **Coastal Zone:** The area that extends from the high tide mark on land to the edge of the continental shelf, which is the submerged part of the continent.
2. **Earth Summit:** The high level inter-governmental meeting on environment of the earth held in Rio-de-Janeiro, brazil in june 1992.
3. **Global Warming:** The slow gradual rise in the temperature of the earth due to emission of excess quantities of radiation-trapping gases.
4. **Local Authority:** An official body responsible to a higher body doing some of the administrative and welfare work of the locality e.g., Panchayats.
5. **Health:** The condition in which the body is sound and the mind is free,
6. **Aerosol:** Fine liquid, solid or gas particulates that remain suspended in the atmosphere for varying periods.
7. **Logging:** Activity of felling trees and preparing the timber.
8. **Gully:** A ravine formed by the action of water.
9. **Biomass:** Organic matter used as fuel specially in a power station for the generation of electricity.

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